

NewsBot Intelligence System Reflective Journal

Midterm Project Report

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ITAI 2373 – Natural Language Processing | Spring 2026

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May 2, 2026

Introduction

For this project, I was responsible for implementing and integrating the full NLP pipeline for the NewsBot Intelligence System. This included text preprocessing, TF-IDF feature extraction, multi-model classification, sentiment analysis using VADER, and named entity recognition using spaCy. I also developed the system integration component, which combines all modules into a single pipeline capable of processing new articles from input to insight generation.

In addition to coding, I focused on structuring the project for clarity and usability. I organized the Jupyter notebook into logical sections, added detailed comments to explain each step, and created a comprehensive README file to document the system's functionality. I also ensured that all visualizations were consistent and meaningful, including category distributions, sentiment analysis, and entity extraction insights.

Technical Integration Challenges

During development, I initially worked with an alternate dataset but encountered limitations related to structure and usability. I transitioned to a more suitable dataset (News Category Dataset), which improved consistency across preprocessing, classification, and analysis stages.

The most significant challenge in this project was integrating multiple independent components into a cohesive system. Each module—classification, sentiment analysis, and named entity recognition—worked individually, but combining them into a single pipeline required careful coordination of inputs and outputs.

Another challenge involved feature alignment in the classification model. The TF-IDF vectorization process needed to be consistent between training and prediction, and additional features such as sentiment and text length had to be handled carefully to avoid mismatches in model input dimensions.

Working with spaCy for named entity recognition also presented challenges, particularly in handling edge cases such as empty or short text inputs. Additionally, managing different data structures across modules (DataFrames, dictionaries, and model outputs) required attention to detail to ensure compatibility.

Future Enhancements

There are several opportunities to improve the NewsBot system. First, classification performance could be enhanced by incorporating more advanced models such as transformer-based architectures (e.g., BERT) instead of traditional machine learning models.

Second, the entity analysis could be expanded to include relationship mapping between entities, allowing the system to identify connections between people, organizations, and locations. This would significantly increase the analytical depth of the project.

Another improvement would be the addition of a user interface, such as a Streamlit dashboard, to allow users to input articles and view results interactively. This would make the system more accessible and closer to a real-world application.

Finally, incorporating real-time data sources, such as news APIs, would allow the system to process live data rather than static datasets.

Business Value Assessment

The NewsBot Intelligence System provides clear business value in several areas. For media companies, it enables automated content categorization and routing, reducing manual effort and improving efficiency. For market research, it allows organizations to track sentiment and identify trends across different categories of news.

The entity recognition component adds additional value by identifying key actors, organizations, and locations within articles. This supports better information retrieval, content tagging, and trend analysis.

Overall, the system demonstrates how NLP can transform unstructured text into structured, actionable insights. While the current implementation is a prototype, it reflects real-world use cases in content management, business intelligence, and data-driven decision-making.

Professional Development Impact

This project significantly strengthened my understanding of how individual NLP techniques come together to form a complete system. Rather than learning concepts in isolation, I gained experience integrating multiple components into a working pipeline.

I also developed stronger problem-solving skills, particularly in debugging integration issues and ensuring consistency across different parts of the system. Additionally, working with tools such as scikit-learn, spaCy, and VADER improved my confidence in applying real-world AI and machine learning techniques.

Most importantly, this project helped me better understand the practical applications of AI in business contexts. It reinforced my interest in using AI as a tool for analysis and decision-making rather than purely technical development, which aligns with my long-term career goals.

Github Repository URL: <https://github.com/NichelleG/ITAI2373-NewsBot-Midterm>

News Category Dataset URL: <https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/rmisra/news-category-dataset>